



Flow of working with difficult users

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What to do with difficult users

At least once during your time as an expert, you have encountered an emotionally difficult user. Most often, they make you nervous, make you feel bad about yourself, doubt your actions, and show disagreement in every possible way.

Communicating with them brings moral discomfort, but there are many whales among such users, so they still need your expert help.

How to recognize a difficult user

In addition to specific vocabulary, an unpleasant tone, and doubting your words, such users may have stories that are not quite typical of the ones they came with.

Most often, their situation has no quick solution and may even look like a stalemate. For example, the ex blocked them 3 years ago, and the user wants to get back to him. Users may have a tendency to obsessive, abusive, manipulative behavior, or be morally exhausted. Or this applies to them.

How to set up to work with a difficult user

No matter how much you want to, you can't run away from the problem, so you need to start by working on the mindset. Next, let's look at a few thoughts that will help you understand the user, and therefore build the right communication with them.

First and foremost, our users are people, and without knowing all their life circumstances, we cannot, as experts, make hasty conclusions and react accordingly.



Users want to feel that they are really heard and cared for.

Users do not always know how to describe their needs, and may deliberately provoke with their behavior, words, or rude tone to make sure they are noticed. Sometimes their challenging behavior is a signal that they need help, but they are unable to express it directly.



Users have the right to be angry.

Anger is a natural emotion that is evolutionarily embedded in us as a bargaining tool. Sociological research proves this.

Most often, they feel unappreciated and thus try to control the situation. By expressing anger, they give more value to their situation and "negotiate" for a better solution for themselves.



Users are not angry at you, but at their life circumstances.

Don't take a defensive or victim position, because this will turn you against the user. Instead, ask yourself, "How can I help this person? What happened to them that they came to me in such a terrible state?" Investigate everything that could cause your user's anger.

"Be kind, for everyone you meet is fighting a hard battle."

Reverend John Watson

Understanding these things will help you distance yourself from negative emotions. It will also make it easier to perceive the other person, which, in turn, will lead to a better understanding of the user's pain and needs. Everyone can have a bad day.



Use a "beginner's mind".

A beginner's mindset - also known as a Zen mindset - is a strategy for approaching every situation as if you were a beginner. This approach prevents you from being prejudiced against the user's situation.

Your experience may create a cognitive distortion that the user should meet some kind of standard, or should know something/ have experience in something you haven't talked about yet. Or because it seems right to you.

You are undoubtedly experts, but are you an expert on this particular user and this particular situation that you encountered in a conversation with this particular person?

How to deal with difficult users on a call when a conflict situation arises 🚨

At any time, and especially in a critical moment, do not forget about strategic thinking - think about the consequences of your actions in the future and where you plan to move in this chat.

React quickly

The longer you keep silent or ignore the problem, the harder it will be to solve it later, because the user's emotional state will deteriorate with each passing minute. And they may start to get angry not only at their problem, but also at the fact that you are not solving it and hospitality.

It's always easier to get screwed than to get untwisted.



The first marker that you have started working on the problem and are "putting out the fire" is a change in tone of voice and empathy.

Be realistic

Do not create expectations that you cannot fulfill, because **it is the mismatch between the promise and the result that causes negative emotions.**

Don't promise that you'll fix the situation for sure, because it may not be possible. **Make it a point to make the user feel important and heard in the first**

few minutes.

How you can do it:

- Express contextual empathy
- verify emotions
- thank the user for sharing their story - make it clear that their story is important, even if it seems to you that it is something insignificant
- give an opportunity to speak out

Show that you care about your actions

Be careful not to ask for important information that the user has already provided, or ask the same question if the user has already provided an answer and knows that you have it. This can make them even angrier. Take notes on important details for yourself.

Personalize your message to make the user feel that the approach to solving their problem is unique.

The user has a trigger, so to prevent the escalation of negative emotions, **you should explain in more detail what you're going to do next and why.** The user will understand your next steps and focus more on this than on their negative emotions.

Show that you are working on their problem and trying to find different solutions - tell them what kind of reading you will do next, what it will give the user, what the result may be.

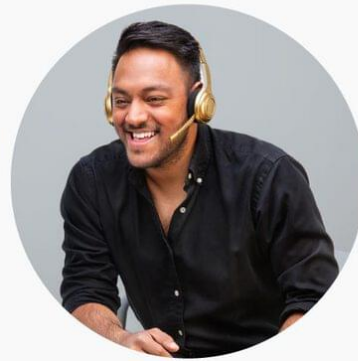
Demonstrating that you are willing to work for them rather than take the easy way out is very important, even if it leads to the same result.

Use positive language

It's not about assurances that everything will be fine, but about providing information.

Using positive words in the dialog shows that you are happy to help and want to work together to find a positive solution.

Positive alternatives to negative language for customer service



Instead of...

- ❌ "I don't know..."
- ❌ "I can't..."
- ❌ "You'll have to..."
- ❌ "Calm down..."
- ❌ "That's not our fault..."

Say...

- ✅ "Great question, I will find out."
- ✅ "What I can do is..."
- ✅ "Would you mind..."
- ✅ "I understand why you feel that way..."
- ✅ "I apologize for the frustrating situation..."

What to do with a constantly difficult user

If a user is difficult, they are not mentally ready for change, so reading that does not match their perception will be perceived as hostile and you will have emotionally difficult situations. Therefore, his retention can be based on expanding his picture of the world in relation to this pain.

Do not rush to "cure" the person, your help can be to maintain the condition that exists at this stage.

To begin with, let's look at the triggers

They can be divided into internal (those that occurred directly in the chat) **and external** (those that occurred in the user's life). You can only influence the internal ones, and you'll have to find and work through the external events that

caused negative emotions. To do this, try asking clarifying questions and acting as if you were in a conflict situation.

Now let's focus on internal triggers. These can be:

- **changing the tone of voice** - when you change the intonation, vocabulary, address, emotional level, and emotional coloring of your reading, the user may decide that you have some prejudice against them and the situation, that you have no desire to help and solve the problem.
- **change of direction, focus of reading** - reading could be a support, something stable, and because of the changes, he felt a loss of stability and became nervous; he was fixated on the question, changes could be perceived as a change in routine and cause discomfort.
- **clarifying questions** - the user perceives the question as more of an attack and tries to defend himself, perhaps not knowing what he wants or not being ready to verbalize it.
- **information that goes beyond the user's perception** - the user does not have the resources to adapt the reading to his or her picture of the world, and everything else may be perceived with hostility and distrust, thinking it is not true.
- **mismatch of the reading with the life situation** - when two types of triggers are combined, the message is perceived as a deception, because in reality the opposite happened.

How to keep a difficult user engaged



Remain calm and confident in yourself

Do not "fall for" a negative tone or aggression; this is provocative behavior that is more aimed at testing you emotionally. There can be many reasons for this: from the desire to choose a worthy expert to subconscious self-defense due to an attack.

If you remain calm and don't give in to provocation, the user will mirror your behavior or get an insight that you can be worked with.



Be positive

Keep your tone and conversation positive and hopeful, **if you see that the user is not yet ready for drastic or negative messages, postpone them** so as not to scare or embarrass the user.

The user can consciously or subconsciously provoke you to conflict with his nervous behavior, provoking the same unbalanced and emotional reaction from you. But your positive attitude can stop them, because they don't get the opposite reaction, as if they heard that you still see something good in them, respect them, hear them, and share their emotions.

Your help is to keep the user stable. But...



Don't forget about the balance of positive and negative.

This will help you avoid situations where the reading does not correspond to life events and new information in a different emotional way is not perceived harshly and hostilely. The ratio of positive to negative should not be 50/50 in all cases, but should depend on the specific situation.



Provide value

Reading:

If you see that the user is focused on one question, delve into valuable info, describe more details, and speak to the essence of the problem.

Summarize what you've already said so that the user can reflect again and feel the value you've provided.

Also, sound expert, justify your reading, explain where the information came from, which will help calm the user down. Or sometimes you can even resort to tricks:

For example, the expert allegedly (with the user's permission) talked to a woman who can check past lives, energies, and connections. This expertise reinforced the belief in our expert and the weight of his words.

User:

Namely, pay attention to him as a person. In difficult situations, there are problems with self-esteem and self-understanding, so along with useful information, make them feel important.

It doesn't necessarily have to be a change in the vector of liquidation, but rather additional support and possible internal insights.



Support

Support can be expressed:

- in expressions of empathy
- in your pleasant tone of communication
- reassurance that it is possible to perform an action that the user wants to do, but is afraid
- emotional and psychological support

Give them faith in themselves, their strength, the right decisions, and the desire to move on. Validate all the emotions that the user receives, share them, and, if necessary, show the vector in which to move. And make it clear that you will always be there for them.



Personalize

Add details that you received during the conversation, create rituals using, for example, a mantra by name or zodiac sign, so that the user feels that they are being treated individually, and that your attention is now focused on them.



Add interactivity

It can be rituals or remedies, a change of tarot card deck, or a tool. In this way, you will engage the user in your reading, shift the focus from the problem to its solution, and it can also help calm them down.



Take notes on details

Make sure you keep a note of all the details about the person's life that you get during the conversation. This is important because during an audio call, you won't see the actual chat, and it will be difficult for you to recall the details that the user told you about their life. Taking notes will help you to see everything the user mentioned in front of you and use it in your conversation with them.

Unfortunately, there are few cases when users share their desire to commit suicide, so we should be prepared for handling such situations.

What to do when a user tells you about it

1. Calm down

The fact that a user has reached this state is not your responsibility, it can happen, it is a feature of a person's behavior and life path, perhaps a certain disease, it does not even depend on them.

2. Accept the situation

What we cannot change, we accept. Then it is easier to focus on what is within our area of responsibility - providing support and expressing empathy.

3. Develop an action strategy

!! It is important not to make assumptions or judgments. If a person with autism tells you that they are suicidal, you should believe them and do what you can to help.

In your communication strategy, emphasize support, analyze whether useful information will help the user distract from their thoughts or improve their mood. If not, focus only on emotional support.

4. Start communicating

Be in your communication:

- Non-judgmental
- Be calm and broadcast your calmness through your tone

- Be open to conversation and encourage people to share their feelings, sensations, experiences, emotions

Users need communication, so they will feel socialized, supported, and that they are not alone.

Include an offer of assistance in your strategy.

!! You can instead advise users to contact a mental health practitioner. If you still want to provide hotlines, you can google national suicide prevention lines or mental health lines, such as 988 in the US or 999 in the UK https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/List_of_suicide_crisis_lines. There are also non-governmental lines - it is better to look carefully at their reputation.

A script for such cases

! Darling I'm really sorry that you're going through this, I understand you and your feelings. Thank you for your honesty and opening up with me, I really appreciate it. You don't have to deal with this on your own because I'm always here and I really want to help you feel better. In such cases, I always recommend contacting specialists who have the necessary experience and knowledge to provide you with the appropriate support. A qualified examination can help identify factors affecting your well-being or health and find optimal solutions for further better health
Your health and comfort are extremely important, and qualified care can be the first step to improving your condition.
Do you know where you can turn for help from a qualified specialist?

What should be in the call:

1. **Empathy and care.** Show the user that you care, that you recognize the user's feelings and that they are important to you: "I'm really sorry to hear that you're feeling this way, and I want to help." Provide valuable and personalized empathy so that it doesn't sound generic.

Watch your tone of voice as you present this empathy. It should be

compassionate, confident, and sincere.

The user should NOT feel that you are confused or indifferent.

2. **A calm tone of communication.** The user should not feel that their problem has made you panic or feel insecure. The user has already faced an unpleasant period in his life and he expects that the person he has turned to for help will know how to deal with it. Therefore, your tone of voice should be the same throughout the entire communication and show confidence and understanding of the problem.
3. **Active listening.** Show that you are fully engaged in the conversation and focused on their feelings: "I'm here to listen," or "I want to understand what you're going through." Also show emotional involvement in the conversation, don't make the user feel like no one is listening, and give short emotional reactions.
4. **Mirroring emotions.** Try to mirror their emotions to confirm and validate the user's experience: "It sounds like you're going through an incredibly difficult time."
5. **Reassurance that the user is not alone.** Make it clear that you are there for them and are ready to be there in difficult moments of their life to support them and share the difficulties: "You don't have to face this on your own. We can find help together."

Don't leave the user alone, prioritize their messages when parsing the messenger so that they receive a response as soon as possible. **This will create a sense of security.**

6. **Open questions.** Encourage users to share their thoughts and feelings by asking open-ended questions: "Can you tell me more about what's been going on lately?"
7. **Take notes on details.** Write down the details that you consider important in the conversation. They will help you to show the user your attention and sincere interest in their problem in the future. They will also help you build the right communication strategy in the future.

✗ What should NOT be on the call:

1. **Judgment and accusations.** Make sure that you do not criticize the user (this can also manifest itself in unsolicited advice on how to do things).
2. **Downplaying the problem.** Avoid phrases that might downplay their emotions, such as "It's not that bad" or "You'll get over it."
3. **Shifting the focus to your own stories without consulting the user.** Share your experiences only after unequivocal confirmation from the user that yes, they want to hear them.
4. **Psychological advice on how to cope with such suicidal thoughts.** If you don't have a university degree and experience working with similar cases, DO NOT provide "professional" help to avoid harming the user.



After a conversation with a user who has suicidal tendencies or thoughts, don't be afraid to ask for help from managers. Reach out to your ASM, QC manager or Education manager. Your QC manager will help you build a strategy for this particular chat so you can provide the user with the service they need right now the most.

You should be prepared for the fact that during the call, the user may ask you questions that require specialized assistance. In such cases, you need to show a lot of empathy, but also make it clear to the user that Tarot or astrology is not a substitute for a specialist consultation.

That is, **if a user asks about an illness, etc., we have no right to refute or confirm the diagnosis, it is better to shift the focus.** For example, write exactly what kind of aura or energy you see in a person, not about their health status. We also note that the best way to help yourself is to consult a specialist.

VERY IMPORTANT



We never diagnose a user. Even if a user asks for an exact diagnosis, we use words like "might, possibly, can, perhaps".

For example, a user asks: "Does my dad have dementia".

Our answer to the user's question should be as follows (of course, it should change depending on the situation):

«Darling, I am sorry that you had to face such kind of difficulties in your life. I see the Magician card. It means that for now, the situation with your dad`s energy didn`t change, but it should be in control, it would be better to have a consultation with a professional. Because cards can`t replace a consultation with a doctor.»



We are not specialists and we have no right to say what we do not know, especially about medical diagnoses.

Here, we need to be as careful as possible and focus on the emotional state of the user, as engagement can be associated with a greater insight into the situation or how the situation will develop in the future.